

An abstract composition of various geometric shapes and patterns. It includes a green right-angled triangle in the top left, a blue semi-circle in the top right, a blue circle on the left, a large orange semi-circle in the center, a green square outline in the bottom right, and a large orange circle in the bottom left. Several yellow curved lines of varying lengths are scattered throughout the composition.

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Outline

- Terminology
 - Signature
 - Formal vs. Actual
 - Parameter Correspondence
- Passing Modes
 - Semantic
 - Actual
- Passing Arrays

Terminology

Prototype/Declaration

Portion of subprogram header that tells us its interface but NOT its implementation

Contains:

1. Return type (if any)
2. Name
3. *Number, Order, and Type* of all Parameters

The type signature OMITS the return type

Parameters

Within a definition:

```
int magic(int a, int b, int c) {  
    return b * b - 4 * a * c;  
}
```

Within a call:

```
int d = magic(a, a + 1, a * 4);
```

Parameters

Within a definition:

Called a **formal parameter**

- A “dummy” variable listed in the signature
- Used within the function’s implementation

Within a call:

Called an **actual parameter**

- Represents a value or address
- Determined at the point of execution



Parameter Correspondence

Actual Parameters must map to **Formal Parameters**

How do you think we should be able to map these?



Parameter Correspondence

Positional

- First actual parameter corresponds to first formal parameter, second actual parameter corresponds to second formal parameter, ...
- Can make correspondence mistakes with long lists
- Easy to check/implement

Keyword

- The name associated with the formal parameter must be used at the call site
- Parameters can appear in any order: `f (a3 = "hi", a2 = 10, a1 = True)`
- Intent can be clearer, but it's harder to check/implement

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Passing Modes

Semantic Models

- In mode

Information is sent TO the subprogram

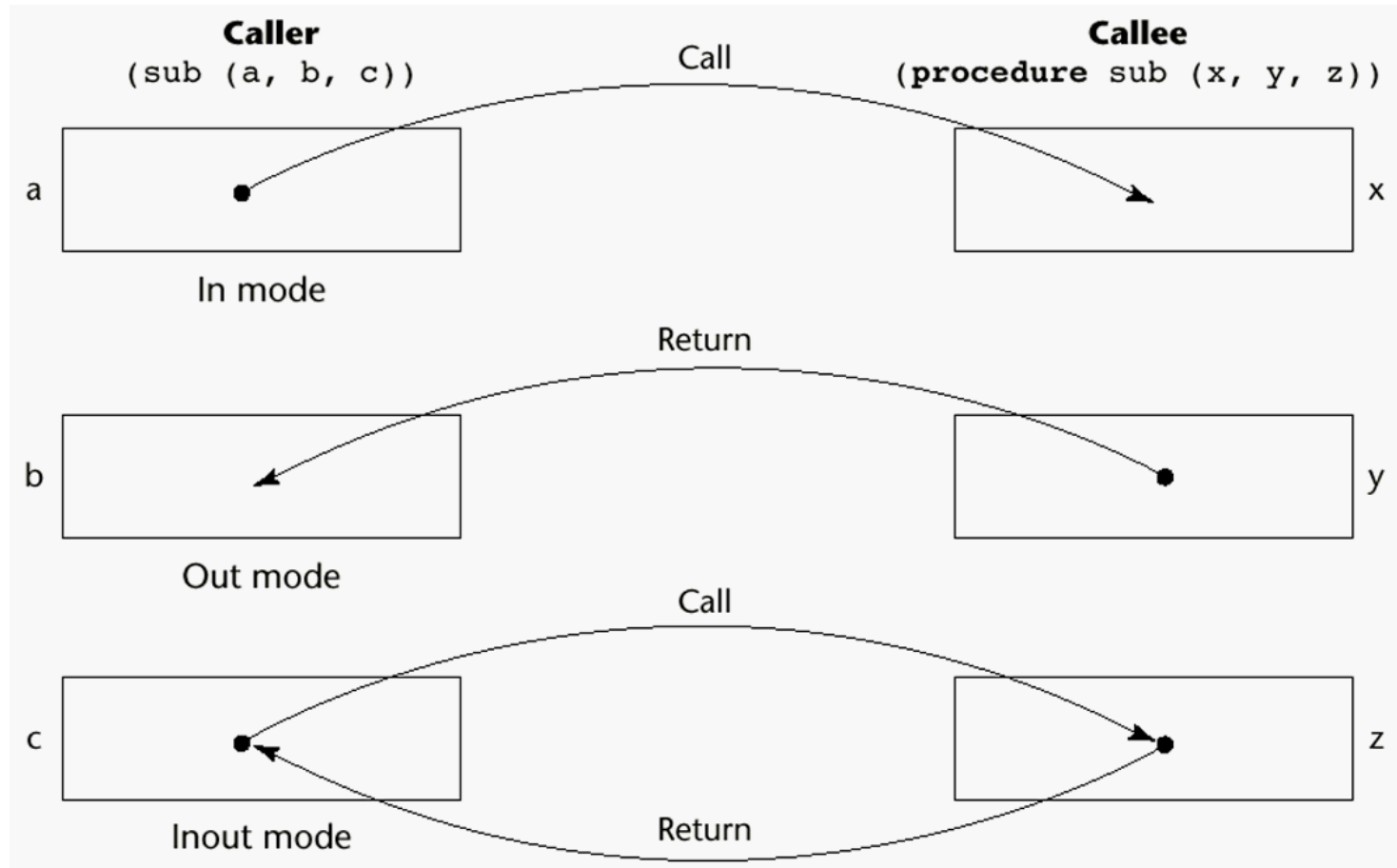
- Out mode

Information is retrieved FROM the subprogram

- In-Out mode

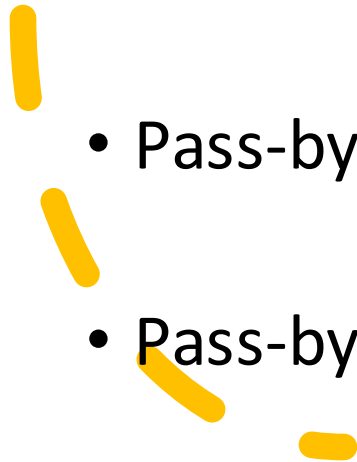
Information is (sent/received) (to/from) the subprogram

Semantic Models





Implementation Models

- Pass-by-Value
 - Pass-by-Result
 - Pass-by-Value-Result
 - Pass-by-Reference
 - Pass-by-Name
- 

Pass-by-Value (In mode)

- **Value** of the actual parameter is used to initialize its corresponding formal parameter
- Underlying value is usually *copied* from one memory cell to another
- *Advantages:*
 - Simple
- *Disadvantages:*
 - Additional storage required
 - Copied value can be large (in space)

Pass-by-Value

```
int by_value (int x) {  
    int y = 4;  
    x += 4;  
    return y + x;  
}  
  
int y = 3;  
int z = by_value (y);  
// y =  
// z =
```

Pass-by-Value

Most languages do pass-by-value as default:

- C/C++
- Java
- C#
- JavaScript
- Python

Pass-by-Result (Out mode)

- There is NO passed initial value, but the formal parameter acts like a local variable
- When control flow returns to caller, copy the result back to a memory cell
- *Advantages:*
 - Useful for when you have multiple “outputs”
- *Disadvantages:*
 - For `fun(x, list[x])` should the address of `list[x]` be determined before or after execution?
 - Special semantics need to be determined for calls that use the same memory cell twice: `fun(a, a)`

Pass-by-Result

```
void by_result (int x) {  
    // int y = x + 2; // Error!  
    int y = 2;  
    x = y + 4;  
}
```

```
int y = 3;  
by_result (y);  
// y =
```


Pass-by-Result (C# Example)

```
static void Main()
{
    double radiusValue = 3.92781;
    CalculateCircumferenceAndArea(radiusValue,
        out double circumferenceResult, out var areaResult);
    System.Console.WriteLine($"Circumference of a circle with a radius of
{radiusValue} is {circumferenceResult}.");
    System.Console.WriteLine($"Area of a circle with a radius of
{radiusValue} is {areaResult}.");
    Console.ReadLine();
}

public static void CalculateCircumferenceAndArea(double radius,
        out double circumference, out double area)
{
    circumference = 2 * Math.PI * radius;
    area = Math.PI * (radius * radius);
}
```

Pass-by-Value-Result (In-Out mode)

- Expected combination of pass-by-value and pass-by-result
- Also called pass-by-copy (copy ALL THE THINGS)
- Formal parameters all have local storage

Pass-by-Value-Result

```
void by_value_result (int x) {  
    int y = x;  
    x = y + 4;  
}
```

```
int y = 3;  
by_value_result (y);  
// y =
```



Pass-by-Value-Result

Very few languages use pass-by-value-result:

- Fortran



Pass-by-Reference (In-Out mode)

- Instead of passing a value, pass an access path (i.e. memory address)
- Also called pass-by-sharing
- *Advantages:*
 - Lower memory footprint
- *Disadvantages:*
 - Slower access (must dereference to retrieve value)
 - Potential side effects (multiple reference updates)
 - Aliasing decreases readability

Pass-by-Reference

```
void by_reference (int x) {  
    int y = x;  
    x = y + 4;  
}
```

```
int y = 3;  
by_reference (y);  
// y =
```

Pass-by-Reference

Most languages can use pass-by-reference:

- C++ (use of &)
- C# (**ref** keyword)
- ~~Java (reference semantics for objects)~~
- ~~Python* (for mutable types)~~

Pass-by-Name (In-Out mode)

- Literal text substitution
- Formals bound at time of call
- Values bound at time of reference or assignment
- *Advantages:*
 - Provides the latest possible binding
 - Extremely flexible
- *Disadvantages:*
 - No obvious semantics by looking at it

*It was possible to do this natively in ALGOL;
harder to do today due to language design decisions.*

Pass-by-Name (Jensen's Device)

```
#define SUM(Type, Var, Low, High, Term) \  
{ \  
    int low = (Low); \  
    int high = (High); \  
    Type sum = (Type)0; \  
    for (int Var = low; Var <= high; ++Var) { \  
        sum += (Term); \  
    } \  
    sum;  
})
```

Pass-by-Name (Jensen's Device)

```
double sum = SUM(double, i, 1, 100, 1.0 / i);
```

```
// expands to
```

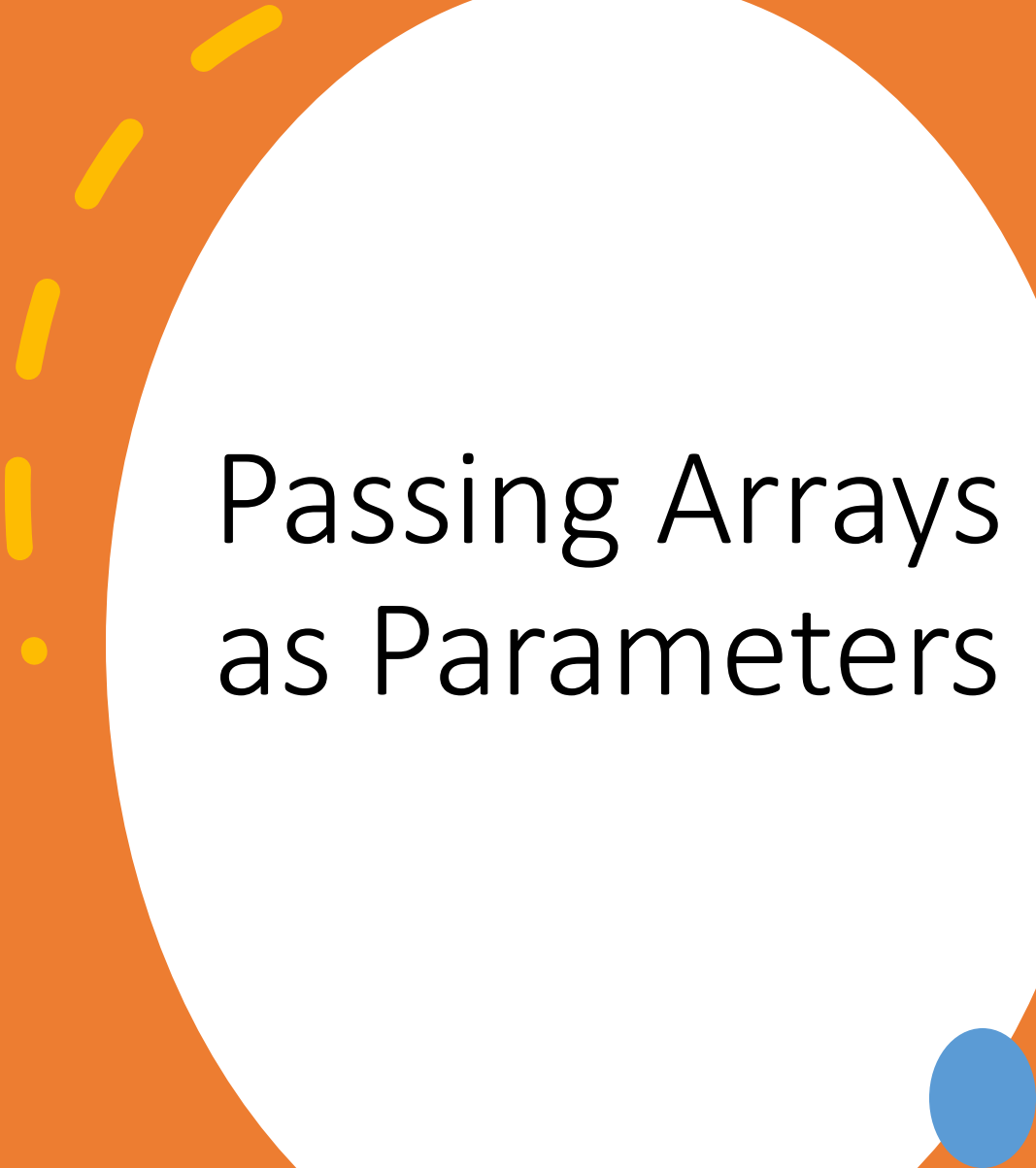
```
double sum = ({  
    int low = (1);  
    int high = (100);  
    double sum = (double)0;  
    for (int i = low; i <= high; ++i) {  
        sum += (1.0 / i);  
    }  
    sum;  
});
```

Pass-by-Name (Jensen's Device)

```
double prod = SUM(double, i, 1, 100,  
                  SUM(double, j, i, 100, i * j));
```

// expands to

```
double prod = ({  
    int low = (1);  
    int high = (100);  
    double sum = (double)0;  
    for (int i = low; i <= high; ++i) {  
        sum += ({  
            int low = (i);  
            int high = (100);  
            double sum = (double)0;  
            for (int j = low; j <= high; ++j) {  
                sum += (i * j);  
            }  
            sum;  
        }));  
    }  
    sum;  
});
```

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Passing Arrays as Parameters

Languages Where Passing Arrays is Fine and Works as Expected

C#

D

Java

Python

JavaScript

Ruby

Perl

PHP

Lisp

OCaml

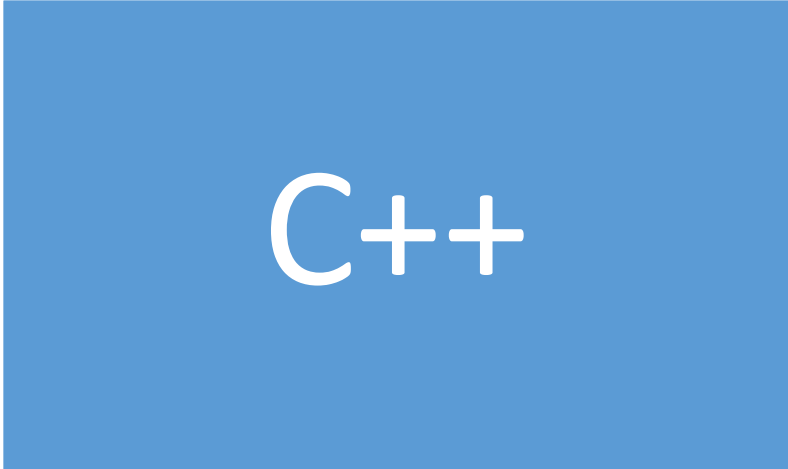
F#

Fortran

Languages Where Passing Arrays is Weird



C



C++

Array Passing in C/C++

Definition of a static or fixed stack array in C:

```
int arr[5];
```

Type of `arr` is `int[5]`

Passing `arr` as a parameter will decay its type.

Decay means coercion with loss of information.

```
int*
```

Array Passing in C/C++

Definition of a fixed heap-dynamic array in C++:

```
int* arr = new int[5];
```

The type of `arr` is `int*`

Passing `arr` as a parameter doesn't change its type:

```
int*
```


Array Passing in C/C++

We don't want heap-based and non-heap-based arrays to interact differently, so they need to be converted to a common type

- Though it is possible to accept only fixed arrays!

Multi-Dimensional Array Passing in C++

```
double m[3][4];
```

```
// valid
```

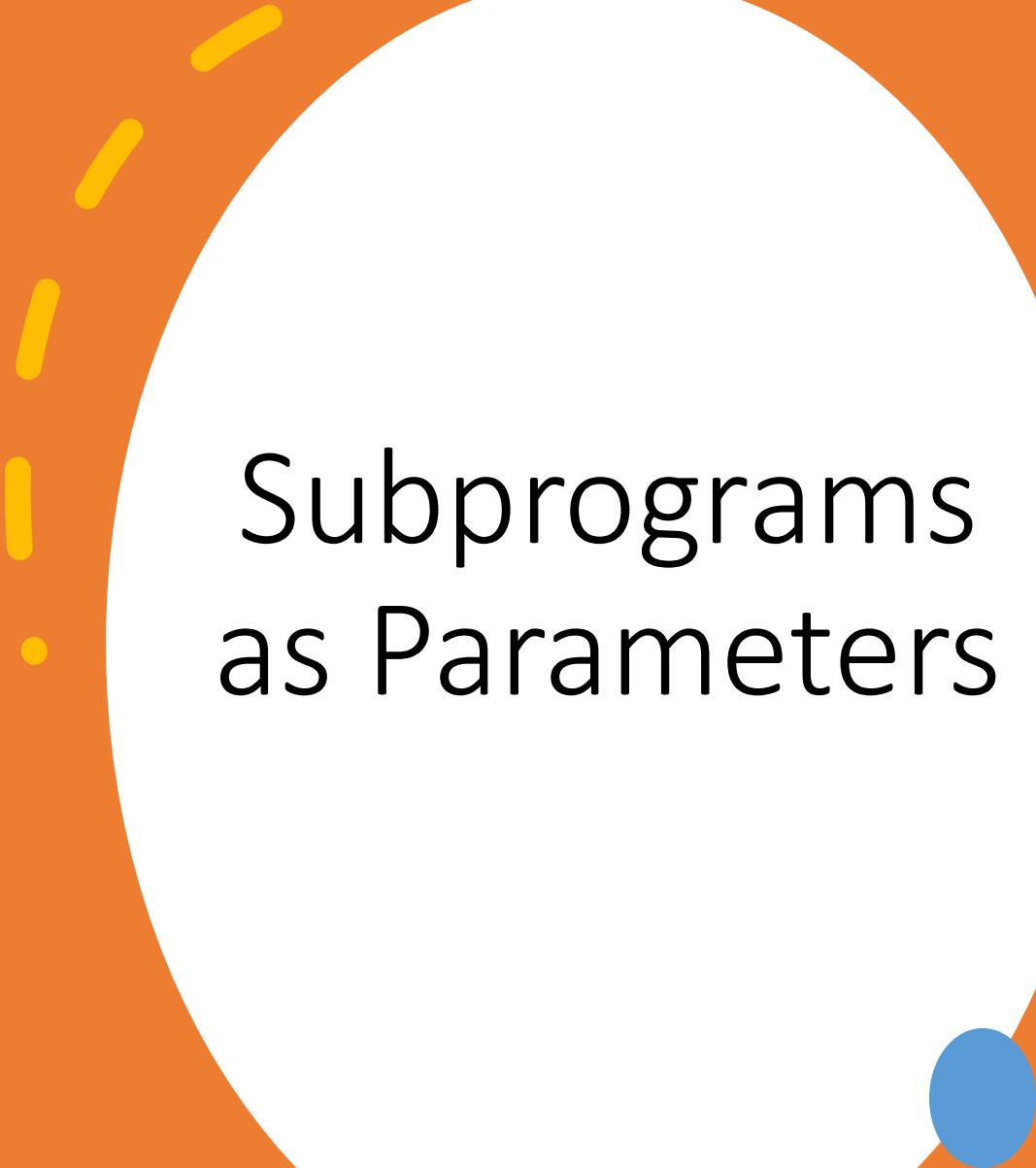
```
void mat_inverse (double (&m)[3][4])
```

```
void mat_inverse (double* m[4])
```

```
// invalid
```

```
void mat_inverse (double** m)
```

Decay on outer-most dimension **only**

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Subprograms as Parameters

Referencing Environment

How do we resolve non-local references for subpgm. passed as param?

- *Shallow binding*: environment where the function is called
 - Most natural for dynamic-scoped languages
- *Deep binding*: environment where the function is defined
 - Most natural for static-scoped languages
- *Ad hoc binding*: environment where the function is passed



```
function sub1() {  
  var x;  
  function sub2() {  
    alert(x);  
  };  
  function sub3() {  
    var x = 3;  
    sub4(sub2);  
  };  
  function sub4(subx) {  
    var x = 4;  
    subx();  
  };  
  x = 1;  
  sub3();  
}
```



Shallow: Caller
Deep: Defn.
Ad hoc: Passer

Shallow: x = 4
Deep: x = 1
Ad hoc: x = 3

Attribution

Slides originally developed by William Killian,
modified by Stephanie Schwartz

modified by Gary Zoppetti

modified by Jingnan Xie

Sources include Robert Sebesta's [Concepts of Programming Languages](#)